

Chapter One

The Nature and Scope of Marketing Research

Introduction

Research always starts with a question to which we seek an answer using scientific methods. We define the question as a Problem. *Research* is often described as an active, diligent, and systematic process of inquiry/investigation aimed at discovering, interpreting and revising facts. Undertaking research is basically applying ***scientific methods*** to find solution to a problem. It is a systematic and explorative study carried out to analyze and apply various solutions to a defined problem.

The Definition of Research

The term research consists of two words:

Re +search

- ❖ Re = Means again and again
- ❖ Search = Means to find something

Therefore, *Research* is a process by which a person observes the phenomena again and again from different dimensions and collects data to draw conclusions on the basis of data. It defined as a search for knowledge.

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- ❖ *Research* is defined as a scientific and systematic search for gaining information and knowledge on specific topic or phenomena.
- ❖ According to *Redman and Mory*; Research is systematized effort to gain knowledge. Some people consider research as a movement from known to unknown. It is actually a voyage to discovery.
- ❖ It is a systematic attempt to obtain answers to questions about events through the application of scientific procedures.

What is marketing research?

- ❖ *Marketing Research* is a systematic and objective study of problems pertaining to the marketing of goods and services.
- ❖ The American Marketing Association (AMA, 1961) defines it as the systematic *gathering, recording and analyzing* of data relating to the marketing of goods and services.
- ❖ The aim of *marketing management* is to satisfy the needs of the consumer. Marketing research helps in achieving this. Marketing research is a systematic and logical way of *assessing ways* of satisfying customer needs.

Research methods Vs Methodology

Research methods may be understood as all those methods/ techniques that are used for conduction of research. It refers to the methods researchers use in performing research operations. Whereas *research methodology* is the way to systematically solve the research problem. It may be understood as a science of studying how the research is done scientifically. In short research methodology has many dimensions and research methods do constitute a part of the research methodology.

The role of Research

- Marketing Research is very much essential to make strategic decisions which are important for the growth of the organization.
- It helps in making the right decisions systematically using statistical methods.
- Marketing Research reduces the uncertainty in the decision-making process
- It increases the probability and magnitude of success if conducted in a systematic, analytical, and objective manner.

The Scientific Method of Research Process

- ❖ *The Marketing Research* Process involves a number of inter-related activities which have bearing/influences on each other.
- ❖ The research process consists of a number of closely related activities.

1. Defining the Research Problem

- ❖ The individual or the organization can be said to have the problem only if the individual or the organization does not know what course of action is best.
- ❖ A problem clearly stated are a problem half solved.

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2. Determine research design
3. Identify data types and sources
4. design data collection methods/ forms
5. Determine sampling design and size
6. Collect the data
7. Analyze and interpret data
8. Prepare research report and presentation

The characteristics of a good Research

- ❖ The purpose of the research, or the problem involved, should be *clearly defined* and sharply delineated in terms as unambiguous as possible
- ❖ The research procedures used should be described in sufficient detail to permit another researcher to repeat the research
- ❖ The procedural design of the research should be carefully planned to yield results that are as objective as possible

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- ❖ The researcher should report, with complete frankness, flaws in procedural design and estimate their effect upon the findings
- ❖ Analysis of the data should be sufficiently adequate to reveal its significance, and the methods of analysis used should be appropriate
- ❖ Conclusions should be confined to those justified by the data of the research and limited to those for which the data provide an adequate basis

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- ❖ Greater confidence in the research is warranted if the researcher is experienced, has good reputation in research, and is a person of integrity.

This is the end of chapter one

THANK YOU